

Minutes for Council Meeting – July 14, 2026

Assign decade leaders.... Leaders use the Rosary booklet!

This is the time to let me know that you have an intention to pray for those that are not a Knight.

Skip: Rosary Intentions: for the repose of the souls of Samuel Austin McElroy, Col. Joe Macaluso, Dan St. Andre', James Botsay, Lucille Bailey, Mark Maier, State Administrator Robert Boudreaux, Marcosa Morales, and Robert Ware, Jr. For Aaron Hebert, for the unborn children of expectant mothers; the end of abortion; for all veterans and active/reserve military duty – Ethan Garnett, Jeffrey St. Andre', William B. Fogle III and Stephen Rutherford; for Pope Leo XIV, Archbishop Gregory Aymond; for all Priests including Fr. Brouillette, Fr. Cuong Tran, Fr. Michael Luxbacher, Fr. Jorge Gomez; for our Seminarians - Eddie Bergeron, Caleb Butler, and Mathias Burns. For those in the Diaconate program – Ted Mascaro and Nick Doucet. Cindy St. Andre', Jay Reich, and Dr. Chris Lee, Parker Egan, Suzanne Kelly, Tommy Achord, Greg Voelkel & family, Janice Lewis, Irwin Marant. Poor souls in purgatory and for our own special intentions.

Let us pray – [Glorious Mysteries] 1st Glorious Mystery – *Jesus' Resurrection* 2nd, Ascension), 3rd, Descent of the Holy Spirit), 4th, Assumption of the Virgin Mary), 5th Crowning of Mary in Heaven). **Finish with Our Father, etc.**

Grace and dinner. Thank Ken Nieto for our meal.

1. Call to Order – 1 Rap (all sit) Time 7:32 pm

Brothers, we are about to open this council meeting. The doors shall now be closed and the guards assume their positions.

2. Opening Prayer – 3 Raps (all stand)

Brothers and guests, let us invoke the Divine blessing as [I lead us in The Lord's Prayer] we recite the Opening Prayer:

Opening Prayer and the Our Father - See separate sheet

Mary, Queen of Knights – pray for us.

St. Peter – pray for us.

Blessed Fr. Michael McGivney – pray for us.

3. Pledge of Allegiance

Brothers [and guests], please join me in reciting the Pledge of Allegiance. Then 1 Rap (all sit).

4. Approve Minutes of Prior Meeting

The minutes of the previous meeting were transmitted to all members. Are any additions or corrections required?

I seek a motion to approve the minutes. Brent Landry

Do we have a second to the motion? Tyler Zacharia

All in favor?? The Minutes are approved. 1 Rap

5. Chaplain's Message (if present)

Worthy Chaplain, please enlighten us with your message.

If not, move on.

Questions for Reflection: N/A

6. Grand Knight's Report

Note: Future FIA Activities will be covered in the Program Director's report

Thanks to all of the Knights that cooked jambalaya for the St. Patrick event in New Orleans on June 4. I understand the event went well and Dan Fitzgerald picked up his food, paid for it, and gave us a donation! Good job everyone especially Rick Lewis who served as Cooking Captain!

Thanks to the Brother Knights that handed out Father's Day cards at Masses on Father's Day.

Thanks to the Brother Knights that stepped up to help with the Metro meeting. Attendance was dismal but there was bad weather present. Special kudos to Dylan Polk who cooked Chicken Alfredo for the group. The Degree Team did a great job preparing for the event but unfortunately, no new members showed up. Jerome and I talked about how the Metro might be improved.

KCLS was Saturday, June 27, 2026 in Prairieville, LA. Jerome, Brian, and I attended. Founder's award, an award recognizing the promotion of the organizations insurance and fraternal benefits programs, will be different, 10% of our Associate members (no insurance) must meet with a Field Agent.

The General Agent (David Barnes) will keep track of the Knights that his agents meet with and report it to me monthly. Please send me an email or text when you have met with him so I can verify. It is advisable that each new member meet with the KC benefits agent to learn more about the products offered.

Supreme has also made significant changes to requirements for the Columbian award. The Columbian award recognizes councils for excellence in programming and charitable outreach through our Faith in Action programs. These changes are good, I think. We will hear more about them from our Worthy DGK:

We received a 25 year anniversary certificate & State Deputy award.

We cooked for the conclusion of the ACTS retreat last Sunday after 11:30 Mass. Rick Lewis was Cooking Captain. He had many brother Knights that volunteered to help him.

We will be holding the Officer's Installation banquet this Saturday, July 18 at St. Mary's hall at 5:00 PM. Many can attend the 4:00 vigil Mass before. Turgeau's will be catering the event again this year. We will need some help setting up SMH before the event (10:00 AM). If you did not sign up and still want to go, please see John Doyle. Thanks to John Doyle for arranging the catering.

We are supporting another Brotherhood and Brew event with Council 3061 at their facility at 75050 Hwy 25 on Thursday, July 23 at 6:00 (dinner). Rick Lewis will serve as Cooking Captain and is planning to make White Beans and Shrimp. He will need 4-5 helpers for cooking and set-up at 1pm at the Council 3061 facility and 2-3 people at Noon for prep. We are providing plates and flatware as well as salad/dessert. We are splitting profit with 3061 60/40. They have a few beer types on tap (Bud, Bud Lite, Michelob Ultra). Fr. Bru is

speaking about the life and legacy of Fr. Michael McGivney. \$15 gets you a great meal and 2 beers (or soft drinks). Additional beers cost \$2. Please try to attend and bring other guys with you. This could be a really big success!

There will be a 4th degree exemplification at St. Edmond's in Lafayette on Saturday, July 25 at 9:00AM. Andrew Cowan and Brett Roberts want to attend. If there is anyone else interested in becoming a 4th degree knight, see me after the meeting tonight. I will go with him (them). Candidates must wear a dark (blue, black, or gray) suit, white shirt and a tie. Shoes would be good too.

We are going to be involved in a project that will help an elderly St. Peter Parish couple that live at 235 W 20th Ave in Covington that need a handicap access ramp. The fire department gets called regularly to help them and they are willing to fund the project. It is an elaborate, commercial, permanent ramp designed by an architect and has premium features. James Klonica at our July meeting said that he will take on the project. Charlie Rosevalley has volunteered to help. I think this project will take a while for volunteers to build but I believe we should support it.

We are doing a Church pulpit membership weekend September 12-13. We have volunteer pulpit speakers for all Masses. This worked well last year and we should do it again but we're making it even better by having a fish fry fundraiser Sunday, September 13 after the 9:30 and 11:30 Masses. More details on this next month.

I would like to thank Patrick Egan for his efforts as our Membership Director last year. We added 22 new Knights, mostly young guys. We have a new Membership Director - James Klonica will lead the growth of our Council this Fraternal year. Please support him in all efforts to bring good new men to join us.

I have coordinated the schedule of our Council events with the Rectory and we are set to go.

We now have Seminarian Raffle tickets. The State Council received over \$100k last year and it was split between St. Joseph Abbey and The Seminary in New Orleans.

The budget has been developed and we will now review and approve it. Worthy Financial Secretary Brian Marcel will go over it with us

Motion to accept the budget as presented. Vote. Bill Cochran motioned to accept the budget as presented and Tyler Zacharia seconded. The vote on the proposed budget passed.

When I became Grand Knight, I set some goals for our Council. We have supported our Parish, attained Star Council status, have Cooking Captains for cooking events and have proteges for our FIA programs. For long-term, I hoped to get the average age of Knights in our Council from a 61.4 years old to 58, we are at 60.4. That's why it's long term!

We have a new 20 gallon cast iron cooking pot thanks to the efforts of Rick Lewis who found a used one and has already put it to use!

We received thank you notes from Donna Gardner (Steve's wife) and Caleb Butler (Seminarian) for our help to them.

7. Financial Reports

Worthy Financial Secretary, please share your report with the council. Report on June expenses & income. June Income: \$ 787 June Expenses: \$1,071
June Net Income: \$-284

Savings account/Emergency fund - \$4,591.00

Worthy Treasurer, please share your report with the Council.

Checking Account: \$9,588.28 Savings Account: \$4,661.54

Pennies from Heaven \$937.51 RSVP \$ _____

St. Peter Little Pantry ____ lbs.

8. Membership Report

We now have 180 Council members (22 new members joined this fraternal year).

We will need to vote on the following new prospective members.

Members getting 3rd degree pins/Rosaries - _____

New 2026-2027 Members (0) + 0 transfers

*(*Call for a motion, discussion and vote on admissions and transfers)*

9. Other Reports

FAITH IN ACTION PROGRAMS

Worthy Program Director (**Jerome Buller**) (What do you have?) The number of requirements for each program has been winnowed down to 3 requirements. Quality not quantity has been stressed.

Worthy Brotherhood & Brew committee chairman (**Wade Candies**) - See prior report

Worthy Insurance Agent (**David Barnes**) –

Worthy District Deputy (**Lloyd Alberts**) – please give us your report. Lloyd introduced himself as the new District Deputy.

Disaster Preparedness Director (**Gerald Rogers**) – A weather booklet and pamphlet was provided to those interested.

Worthy 4th Degree Representative (FC, **Ken Nieto**) – please give us your report.

Ken stated that a 4th degree exemplification will be held in Lafayette this month. In addition, a chicken BBQ will be October 10 at the KC hall on Hwy 25. There will be a 4th degree exemplification on November 21 in Baton Rouge.

10. Unfinished Business (motions carried over from previous meetings) -

11. New Business (new motions)

Our Council was blessed to receive a generous \$5,000 donation from a fellow Knight, accompanied by a proposal to establish a stewardship fund. The purpose of this fund is to create a reliable, ongoing source of support that would supplement our annual budget thereby allowing us to focus more fully on the charitable works we are called to do.

In keeping with our responsibility to be prudent stewards of the Council's resources, a committee was formed to evaluate this proposal and develop a thoughtful and sustainable plan. After careful consideration, the committee offers the following recommendations:

1. That the Council accept the donation and establish an investment account with Knights of Columbus Asset Advisors (KCAA). Consultation has already taken place with Matt Maurin, a local Knights of Columbus financial advisor.

2. That approximately \$4,000 currently held in our Capital One savings account be transferred and invested into the same or similar KCAA account.
3. That the Council contribute \$500 quarterly to this fund, with the goal of building the account to a level that can generate approximately \$2,000 annually within about four years. At that time, the Council may choose to discontinue additional contributions based on financial returns and council needs.
4. That KCAA be authorized to invest these funds in conservative, values-based mutual funds managed in accordance with Knights of Columbus principles.
5. That while these funds remain accessible for extraordinary or urgent needs, the primary intent is to preserve and grow the investment in order to achieve our long-term objective of providing a stable source of income to supplement the Council's annual budget.
6. Finally, I wanted to point out that both the Louisiana Department of KoC and Supreme manage similar funds.

Discussion?

Motion: I motion that the Council accepts the donation, creates the KCAA accounts, funds it with Council savings, invests a quarterly amount of \$500 until we can use \$2k/year from the account and still maintain the principal amount. Vince Hammond motioned to accept the donation, create the account and fund it with Council savings. Tyler Zacharia seconded the proposal. Vote on the proposal passed.

ANY OTHER NEW BUSINESS?

Skip! ... (Worthy Financial Secretary, please present any bills not previously approved for payment.)

I will now entertain new motions. (Allow expected motions to be made and discussed, then vote)

12. Good of the Order

KOM June – Chris Forstall - Helped with cooking events, Phil Bruce's yard, Family Picnic, new members brought in, etc.

FOM June – Tony and Ann Avallone - Tony has always been one of our most involved Knights, helping at most events, and providing leadership and advice to Grand Knights after him. His efforts to help Phil Bruce with his yard was a great act of brotherhood. His wife Ann is active in the Church community.

Name(s)

July Birthdays (10) – Michael Maples, Mat Marcel, Stephen Villavaso, Joey Scuderi, Sr, Fr. Cuong Tran, Brian Cochran, David Milla, Ron Wimprine, Blake Luna, Charlie Foy, Cal Bergeron, Brad Deville, Travis Richards, Jake Spellman, Bill Cochran, Levere Montgomery, Chris Buffa, Jake Vicari, Sal Miceli, III, Joe Reich, Rich Ely.

13. Lecturers Reflection

Ken Olson gave a wonderful insight into the making of the Declaration of Independence. For instance, there were 56 delegates who signed the 1300 word document written by Thomas Jefferson.

14. Grand Knight's Summary: May we accomplish our goals and serve the Parish with vigor and integrity in this new Fraternal year!

Next Officers' Meeting – Tuesday, August 4 2026; Next Council meeting is Tuesday, August 11, 2026. Both meetings are at 6:30pm in SMH.

Meeting Meals

July - Ken Nieto

August – Joe Reich

September – Cody Reed

Adoration Schedule – see website. Sunday, 3-4pm -anyone want to participate?

July 19- George Binder

July 26- Rich Ely

Blessed Mother Statue

July – Ken Nieto

August – Irwin Marant

Pennies from Heaven & Random Drawing

Barry Waller won \$76 from Pennies from Heaven.

15. Closing Prayer

Before proceeding to the closing prayer, let me ask: “does any Brother know of a member of this Council, or Brother of the Order, who is sick or in distress other than those that were sent earlier?”

Skip: Fr. Dan Dashner, Deacon Jack Jung, Deacon Charles Attaway, Donald Bonano, Terry Parker, Edsel & Janette Parnell, Janice Wattigny, Ryan Matherne, RJ Matherne, Jim & Frances Vance, Sheree Reich, Mary Foley, Thomas Vennon, Tony Tredente, Don Brewster family, Rich Ely, Bob Guy, John Kelly, Ken & Pat Nieto, Charles Pouche' (Council 9384), Larry Sweeney, Barry Waller, Chico & Mary Ann Morales, J.T. Susdandal, Pipe Hymel, Dan O'Rourke, Tom Cooper, Tommy Benasco, Michael Maples, Phil Bruce, Paul Mandina, Bobby Thompson, Joe Furlan, John & Clare Tortorice, the George Naquin Jr. family, Dalan Bayham, Mike Sakraida, Arthur Esser, Chris Wagner, Chuck & Faye Witkowski, Michael and Caroline Hundsheid, and Cheryl Scuderi, Bob Bradford, Larry Sevenker, **George & Mary Hellen Binder, Irwin Marant.**

3 Raps – Worthy Chaplain (he needs the prayer card), please lead us in the Prayer for Canonization of Blessed Michael McGivney (or Litany of Blessed Michael McGivney) or (Hail Mary) as we pray for the sick and distressed and close this meeting.

Father Bru/Cuong/GK reads prayer from card given to him.

Closing Prayer; “LET US PRAY FOR THE SICK AND DISTRESSED AS WE CLOSE THIS MEETING”.

Closing Prayer –

and Hail Mary - See separate sheet

Mary, Queen of Knights – pray for us.

St. Peter – pray for us.

Blessed Fr. Michael J. McGivney – pray for us.

16. Adjournment

I declare this meeting adjourned – **1 Rap**

Meeting was adjourned at 8:54pm.

Pick up donated cans and copy the attendance sheet to Larry S.

Gavel Protocol

1 Rap – All sit

2 Raps – Officers stand

3 Raps – All stand

4 Raps – All kneel

When praying at meetings and other formal events, Councils may invoke 3 raps of the gavel to stand or four raps of the gavel to kneel. When determining to stand rather than kneel, officers should take into account the age and physical health of the membership.

****** As a sign of respect, it is customary for the Grand Knight to gavel the council to rise when the District Deputy stands to give his report. After members have extended this courtesy, the Grand Knight may gavel the assembly to sit if the speaker has not already asked everyone to be seated.

Name	Date In	Date of Degree	Live Degree	Phone	Member #	Rosary & Pin?
Thad Ackel	9/9/25	9/28/25		504-352-4401	5568248	Yes
Jake Vicari	10/7/25	10/12/25		985-630-0633	5576762	No
Dylan Polk	10/12/25	10/17/25		318-680-9809	5578809	Yes
John Casey						
Blake Luna	10/12/25	10/12/25		504-598-4554	5578926	Yes
Todd Simoneaux	10/13/25	10/21/25	10/21/25	985-966-4379	5579038	Yes
Tyler	9/28/25	10/21/25	10/21/25	985-690-0239	5574103	Yes
Chris Wagner	10/20/25	10/21/25	10/21/25	504-493-1560	5581385	Yes
Jonathan Schouest	10/13/25	10/13/25		504-494-0810	5578950	Yes
Gary Sonjy	11/24/25	12/6/25		985-789-3297	5592488	Yes
Andrew Cowan	12/20/25	12/30/25		504-451-6782	5599322	Yes
Nick Sandoz	12/4/25	12/30/25		504-512-1231	5594236	No
David Wellmeyer	01/02/03	03/09/03	03/09/03	985-630-0201	3842047	Yes
Cody Fulco	01/28/26	2/10/26		985-502-0783	5609195	No
Jake Spellman	02/10/2026	3/10/26	3/10/26	504-605-7644	5613179	No

Hunter Thibodeau	02/20/20 26	4/14/26	4/14/26	985-502-2441	5616147	Yes
Zach	2/28/26					No
Chris Forstall	3/4/26	3/4/26	3/4/26	985-373-1350	5616443	Yes
Kevin Fink	3/17/26	4/14/26	4/14/26			Yes
Stephen Villavaso	05/04/26			225-572-0698		No
Chase Joubert						
David D'Antonio						
Bryan Pigeon				985-789-1816		No